

How to raise a build contract with Claude

Give Claude the build contract request email and it fills in the contract documents for you — using Transpire's own templates off the **Z:** drive, not something it made up. It saves the finished documents to the right place and hands you a review sheet; nothing is ever sent, signed or issued without you.

EVERYDAY GUIDE · CONTRACT ADMINISTRATION

It uses the real template, every time. Claude opens the same blank document you would open from **Z:\PROCEDURES & FORMS\CONTRACTS** and types into it. The wording, the styles, the inclusions list and the page numbering are left exactly as they are — only the fields change. It has been taught which template belongs to which region (Tamworth and Gunnedah jobs share one; Sydney and SEQ have their own), which folders are superseded, and the nine fields on page 1 plus the client name and address blocks on pages 10–13, from the **Raising Contracts** section of the System and Procedures Manual. **It will never invent a contract format.** If it can't find the right template it stops and tells you.

Start here — five steps

1

Open **Claude Desktop** and sign in with your own account.

2

Switch to **Code** mode.

3

Pick the project folder **transpire-claude-code**.

4

Accept the folder-trust prompt. **Once only.**

5

Type `/new-contract-template` and point it at the request email.

The folder to pick in step 3 is **Z:\CLAUDE CODE\transpire-claude-code** — browse to it once and Claude remembers it. Steps 1–4 are a one-off; after that you land straight on step 5 each time. For the email, either save it out of Outlook as a **.msg** file and give Claude the path, or just paste the subject line — it can find the message itself.

What happens when you run it

1 It reads the whole email chain, and the attachments

Including the EOI, even when it is a photo of a signed form.

WHAT IT PULLS OUT

- The buyer's name, from the EOI — not from an email signature
- Design, façade and contract price
- Whether the EOI is marked dual key
- Anything the sales manager asked for — a review first, no prelim agreement, a changed price

Why this matters: these emails get forwarded two or three times. The instruction to you is in the newest part, the job facts are in the oldest part from the marketer. It reads all of it.

Requests to you are repeated back, not acted on. If the email says something should be reviewed or sent, Claude tells you it says that and leaves the decision with you.

2 It picks the template and tells you which one

And why it chose that one, before it fills anything in.

You get back: the full path of the blank template it is about to use. Check it — this is the most useful thing on the screen.

It knows what is out of date. Anything in an `SS` folder is superseded, and there are a lot of them — a dozen old NSW contract files that look perfectly current. It also skips files marked “don’t use” and any template named for a different marketer or estate. If two templates could both be right, it asks rather than guessing.

3 It fills in the inclusions

Page 1, and the client name and address blocks on pages 10 to 13.

THE FIELDS IT COMPLETES

- Lot number, street, suburb, estate and price
- House type, house size, façade and garage side
- Client name in every place it appears, and the full site address
- Builders Representative

You get back: a finished `.docx` and its PDF, plus a list of exactly what changed against the blank template — so you can see it touched the fields and nothing else. A preliminary agreement too, if the job needs one — and the build contract, filled the same way, whenever an approved Word contract template exists (see the table below).

Signatures, dates and initials are left empty. Always. Those are yours and Michael’s to sign.

4 It tells you what it could not fill

This is the part worth reading properly.

TYPICAL FLAGS

- “Garage side isn’t in the email or the plans — it needs confirming”
- “The plans haven’t arrived, so house size is blank”
- “This job already has a contract from June — so this run saved to the testing folder, not the job folder”
- “The ID attachments don’t match the name on the EOI”

You get back: the finished documents saved in the right place, plus a short review sheet listing every field, where each value came from, and every flag. A first draft goes straight into the job’s CONTRACT DOCUMENTATION folder. A job that already has contract documents is treated as a test run: those files go to the template-testing folder instead, and the live job folder is not touched — moving them across is your call.

What it will never do

- **Never** invent contract wording, or a contract format. It fills the company's template or it stops.
- **Never** guess a number that goes in a contract. Price, house size, garage side and the prelim fee are either sourced or flagged for you.
- **Never** sign, initial or date anything, and never send an email or issue anything to DocuSign.
- **Never** overwrite a file that is already in a job folder, and **never** write into a job folder that already has contract documents — a re-run goes to the testing folder for you to check and move across.

It still stops and asks when a real decision is needed — a price that doesn't match the EOI, two templates that could both fit, or whether the job needs a preliminary agreement.

What it produces, and what it doesn't

DOCUMENT	WHAT YOU GET
Inclusions	Filled in, ready to check. The real Word template with all the fields completed.
Preliminary agreement	Filled in , when the job needs one. The fee is never carried over from the template — it asks, because the template figure has been wrong in practice.
Build contract	Filled in too — once the Word version of the contract is approved. Claude converted the licensed NSW and QLD contracts to Word and fills the cover page, the owner block and the land details the same way it fills the inclusions. Until a manager approves those Word versions, a real (production) job still gets the list of values to key in , and test runs produce a practice copy clearly named TEST UNAPPROVED TEMPLATE . Prices, GST, deposit and progress payments always stay yours — they come from DataBuild and Claude never types them.
Plans, general conditions, colour options	Not produced. Listed as a checklist so nothing is forgotten from the pack.

Everything it hands you is a draft. Read it against the email and the plans before it goes anywhere. It is quick and it is careful, but it has not seen the site, spoken to the client, or opened DataBuild.

Getting a good draft

DO THIS	WHY IT HELPS
Include the EOI and the ID	The buyer's name comes off the EOI. Without it, the name is a guess and it will say so
Wait for the plans if you can	House size and garage side come off the plans and nowhere else
Say if it is a dual key or auxiliary dwelling	The standard inclusions do not cover the second dwelling. It flags this, but confirming saves a round trip
Say if this is an amendment	It checks the job folder, but if you already know, say so up front
Give the job number if you have it	Lot numbers repeat across estates; job numbers do not
Read the flags before the document	The flags tell you whether the document is usable yet

If something goes wrong

PROBLEM	FIX
"I can't see the Z: drive"	The task is running in the cloud. Start again in Code mode on your computer.
It says the template has changed	Take this seriously. Somebody has revised the blank template, so Claude stopped rather than produce a half-filled contract. Tell the team — it needs a small update before it will run again.
It left garage side blank	Working as intended. It is read off the site plan drawing and Claude will not guess it. Fill it in yourself, or ask Michael.
The build contract came out named "TEST UNAPPROVED TEMPLATE"	Working as intended. The Word version of the contract hasn't been approved yet, so that copy is for checking only — it can never be issued. Once the approved Word contract is filed in the templates folder, the same run produces it under the real name automatically.
It says the build contract is BLOCKED on a production job	Deliberate — that's the legal gate. A real job's contract is only produced from the manager-approved template. Use the list of values it gives you, exactly as before.
It says a file is "open in another program"	You (or someone) have the old PDF open. Close it and tell Claude to re-run the delivery — nothing needs re-typing.
It says the price on the email and the EOI disagree	It stops on purpose. Don't pick one — get it confirmed.
It won't change the inclusions for an auxiliary dwelling	Also on purpose. Which inclusions apply to a second dwelling is a pricing decision, so it goes to Michael rather than being written by Claude.
The job isn't where you expected	Finished and cancelled jobs move out of the live region folder. Claude checks those too — give it the job number.

Transpire — build contract guide. Questions, or something in here is wrong? Tell the team — this guide is maintained and gets updated as the templates and the procedure change. The field rules behind it are in the project repo under `job-roles/contract-admin/rules/contract-docs.md`, and the template map under `.claude/skills/new-contract-template/references/`.